When Weekly Store Reviews Become Opinion Instead of Evidence

Store Performance Voice Analyst - for field sales and store ops

What Was Delivered

A voice-first sales and store performance analyst that a territory manager uses during store calls and Monday reviews, and that also appears inside the BI dashboard the commercial team already uses.

It answers the questions sales people actually get judged on: which stores are slipping, which SKUs are the real problem, what to push this week, what to replenish before the weekend, what will stock out, what will sit, and what story to tell the buyer without guessing.

How It Behaves When It Is Not Sure

If it cannot back a reason with data, it does not make up a story. It says what it can prove, what is unclear, and what signal is missing — like late inventory feed, missing promo execution data, or unknown out-of-stock window. It will still give the manager a safe next step, like "verify on-shelf availability today" or "confirm promo compliance in Store 18," instead of a fake conclusion.

Update Notifications Delivered

The module sends proactive alerts to sales users based on what they asked in past reviews. If a territory manager keeps asking "why does Store 12 dip on Fridays," the system watches the same store and SKU set. When it sees the same pattern forming again, or sees a new stockout risk before a holiday weekend, it pushes the alert so the manager can act before they get blamed in the weekly call.

Who It Serves

Store managers, territory managers, regional sales leaders, sales ops, category managers, demand planners, inventory planners, supply chain ops.

Client Snapshot

1

What They Do

A US-based food manufacturer selling branded products into retail and foodservice, managing many SKUs across regions and store networks where field sales teams are responsible for growth, distribution, and store execution.

2

Why Sales Teams Were Stuck

Sales reviews were full of pressure questions: "Why did this store drop?" "Why are we out of stock again?" "Why is this promo not working?" "What do you want the plant to produce for next month?" "Which SKUs should we push, and which should we stop forcing?"

The data existed, but it was scattered. By the time the story was built, the week was gone.

3

What Was Already in Place

Dashboards, sales history, SKU lists, promo calendars, and inventory feeds. People still stitched it manually, and most decisions were made on instinct.

Where the Problem Showed Up

These are the real sales scenes the module was built for.

1 Monday Territory Review

A territory manager gets hit with, "Store 27 is down 9 percent, explain it." Before the module, the manager guessed: weather, footfall, competition, or "maybe they did not reorder." The wrong guess makes the manager look weak and wastes the week.

2 Buyer Call with a Retailer

A store manager or buyer asks, "Why did your SKUs not sell last week? Why should I give you more shelf?" Before the module, sales talked in generalities. The buyer expected specifics: SKU, day, availability, promo, and stock movement.

3 Replenishment Firefight Before a Weekend

A manager sees that the weekend is coming, a holiday is near, and two high movers are low in stock. Before the module, they reacted late, and the store stocked out, then sales got blamed.

4 Slow Inventory Sits and Everyone Argues

Some SKUs pile up in Store 14 while Store 9 stocks out. Before the module, teams argued. Nobody could prove whether it was poor ordering, poor promo execution, wrong forecast, or a supply timing issue.

5 Monthly Production and Demand Planning Input

Sales is asked, "What should we produce more of next month, by SKU and region?" Before the module, it was a mix of last month's numbers and confidence, without a clean link to demand drivers like holidays, promo calendars, and footfall.

The Pattern We Saw

What Kept Happening

Sales teams were not losing because they lacked effort. They were losing because the weekly story was not evidence-led. It was built too late and felt like opinion.

The Signature Smell

The same three debates repeated every week:

- "Was it stock, promo, or footfall?"
- "Was it the store or the SKU?"
- "Was it a supply miss or a sales miss?"

Without proof, everything becomes politics.

Why Dashboards Did Not Solve It

Dashboards show **what happened**. Sales needs:

- Why it happened
- What to do next
- What to tell the buyer
- What to request from supply and production

All in minutes, not days.

What We Delivered

The product: Store Performance Voice Analyst module.

What It Does, in Plain Terms

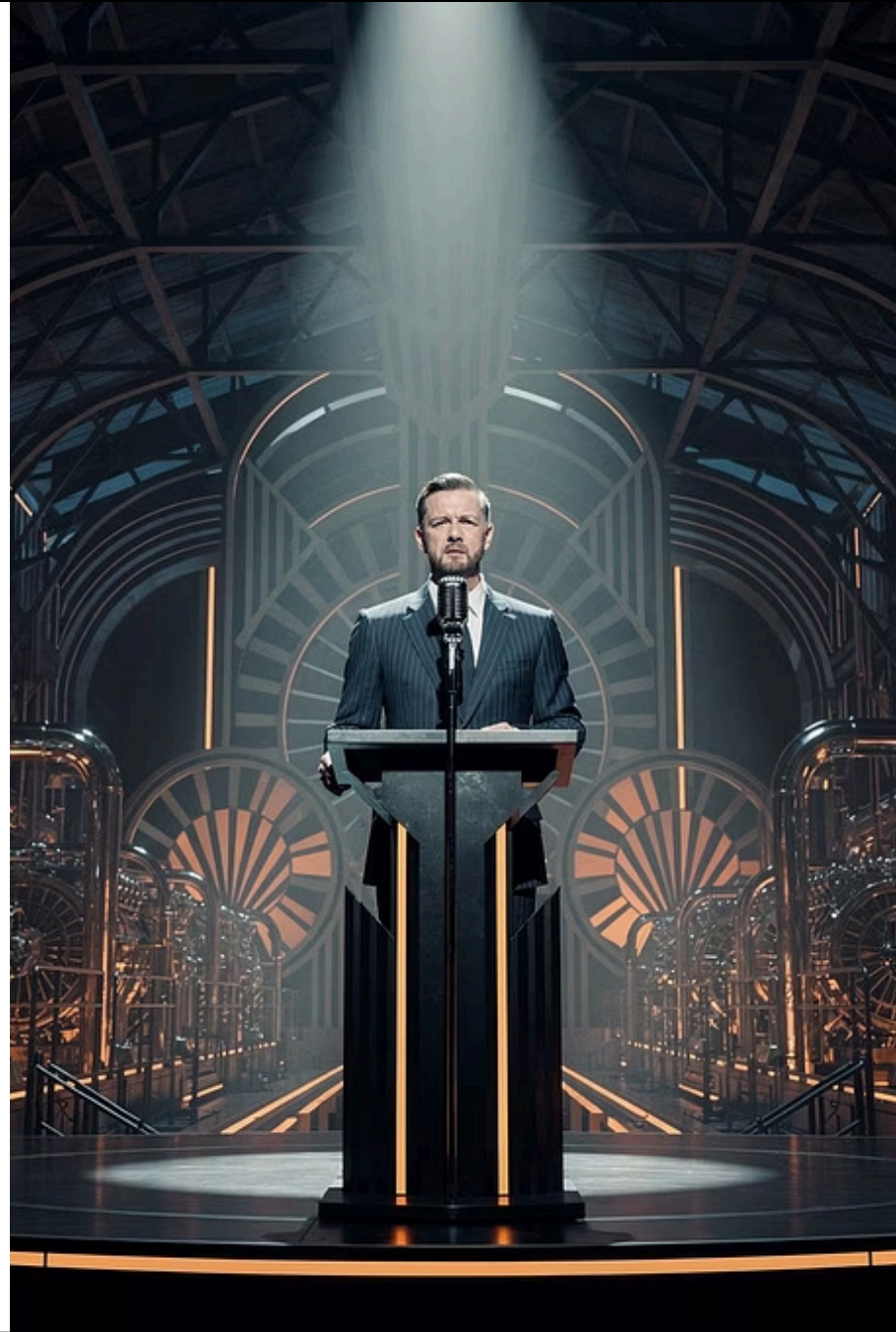
A sales user asks, by voice, a store-level question that normally takes an hour of digging. The module pulls the store's sales history, daily and weekly trend, SKU and category mix, promo calendar, footfall where available, inventory position, and stock movement.

It explains the trend with ranked drivers that are evidence-backed, and it calls out what it cannot prove. It forecasts the next week or month by SKU, category, and store, and highlights risk. It writes back actions into replenishment workflows and creates tasks so field execution happens, not just analysis.

What It Does Not Do

It does not say "probably holiday" if the real issue was out-of-stock.

It does not recommend inventory without showing the trigger.



Where It Sits in Their World

Surfaces Sales People Actually Use

- A mobile app used during store walks, on the road, and before buyer calls
- A voice panel inside the BI dashboard used in weekly and monthly reviews

Integrations It Reads From

- Sales by store, SKU, and week
- SKU catalog and category mapping
- Promo calendar and offer history
- Footfall where available
- Inventory, stock on hand, stock movement, and out-of-stock windows
- Supply signals, delivery timing, and any service issues where available
- External context feeds used by the business, like weather and local disruptions

What It Writes Back

Store-level action tasks: shelf availability check, promo compliance check, display execution, competitor price check, reorder reminder

Replenishment actions: reorder suggestions, transfer suggestions, safety stock levels by SKU, and stockout risk flags

A review-ready summary that a manager can paste into the weekly business review without rewriting

How Sales Users Actually Interact with It

These are the voice questions sales people used in real work.

01

Fix My Weekly Review Story

"Give me the real reason Store 27 is down this week on burgers." The module answers with ranked drivers like: out-of-stock window, promo ended, footfall dip, delivery delay, weather anomaly, and shows what it checked.

02

Prep Me for a Buyer Call

"What should I say to the buyer about the drop in hot dogs last weekend, and what is the fix?" The module produces a short buyer-safe story and a store action plan: reorder timing, shelf check, promo compliance.

03

Protect the Weekend

"Which SKUs will stock out in my top 10 stores before Saturday?" The module flags stockout risk and writes replenishment actions, with reasoning tied to trend and expected lift.

04

Stop Slow Movers from Rotting

"Which SKUs are slow in Store 14 and what should I do this week?" The module flags slow movers, suggests actions like stop replenishment, adjust promo focus, or move stock where allowed, and creates tasks.

05

Tell Supply What to Make

"Forecast next month demand by SKU for my region, factoring holiday weeks and promo plan." The module returns SKU-level forecast and highlights production risk, so sales input to production planning is not guesswork.

Phases the Client Approved

1

Phase 1

Voice Q and A for store, SKU, and category trends with evidence-backed explanations

2

Phase 2

Holiday, promo, and footfall context tied into the explanation

3

Phase 3

Forecasting by store, SKU, and category with risk flags

4

Phase 4

Write-backs into replenishment and task workflows

5

Phase 5

Proactive alerts based on repeat questions, repeat patterns, and upcoming risk windows

Current Status

Completed

- Mobile voice experience built for field sales and store ops
- Voice panel inside BI dashboards
- Evidence-led explanations for rises and drops
- Forecasts by SKU, category, and store
- Write-backs into replenishment and task workflows
- Proactive alerts tied to past review questions and repeat patterns

Underway

- Tightening "driver ranking" so the explanation stays short and punchy for sales reviews
- Improving behavior when one feed is late, like inventory delay, so it stays honest
- Aligning forecast outputs with how demand planning reviews numbers so sales and supply stop arguing

Next

- Add special handling for promotion execution misses, so the module can separate "promo planned" from "promo actually live in store"
- Add store clustering, so similar stores help predict risks earlier
- Add monitoring that flags chronic patterns like Friday dips or repeated stockouts, so territory plans stop being reactive

Proof Gates

- If a reason cannot be linked to a data signal, it cannot be stated as fact
- If inventory feed is missing or delayed, the module must label the explanation as incomplete and tell the user what to verify
- If a replenishment change is suggested, it must include the trigger and the risk it prevents
- Forecasts must be produced at SKU, category, store level as requested
- Write-backs must create tasks with owner and due date, not vague advice
- Proactive alerts must tie to a user's earlier questions or a repeated pattern, not noise

What We Learned

> Sales teams do not need more charts. They need a defensible story in 60 seconds.

> The fastest way to win trust was naming what the system cannot prove, instead of filling the gap with confidence.

> Write-backs mattered more than insights. Sales teams trust things that turn into action, not commentary.

Ready to Replace Opinion with Evidence?

connect via neil.voishift@klyrr.com

- Do your Monday reviews become opinion battles because nobody can prove what drove the store result?
- Do store managers and territory managers spend hours stitching a story that still sounds like guessing?
- Do you get blamed for stockouts even when the real cause was timing, promo execution, or supply disruption?
- Do planners ask you what to produce next month and you have to answer with gut feel?

Talk to us. We will embed the Store Performance Voice Analyst into your BI and mobile workflows so sales teams can explain results with evidence, forecast with confidence, and push replenishment and execution actions before the week is lost.